

Which World of Darkness Game Should I Play?

A quick-pick guide. Find what you want at the table, then start there.

Start with what you want to PLAY

If you want to be...	Play this	Line
A seductive predator caught in immortal politics	Vampire: The Masquerade	oWoD ★★★★★
A furious shapeshifting warrior in a losing eco-war	Werewolf: The Apocalypse	oWoD ★★★★★½
A reality-bending mage whose belief rewrites the world	Mage: The Ascension	oWoD ★★★★★
A normal human who fights monsters anyway	Hunter: The Reckoning (5e)	oWoD ★★★★★
A faerie soul clinging to wonder	Changeling: The Dreaming	oWoD ★★★★★½
A Frankenstein earning the right to be human	Promethean: The Created	CofD ★★★
A trauma survivor stolen by the Fae	Changeling: The Lost	CofD ★★★
A living nightmare — the monster itself	Beast: The Primordial	CofD ★★½
The Remade, out for revenge	Deviant: The Renegades	CofD ★★½

Start with the FEEL you want

- **Easiest buy-in / most support & community** → Vampire: The Masquerade
- **Anger, action, and apocalypse** → Werewolf: The Apocalypse
- **Big philosophical ideas** → Mage (Ascension = freedom · Awakening = structure)
- **Grounded, human, relatable** → Hunter: The Reckoning (5e) or The Vigil
- **Bittersweet and beautiful** → Changeling: The Dreaming
- **Pure tragedy** → Promethean: The Created
- **Hidden gems that punch above their popularity** → Promethean & Changeling: The Lost

Classic (oWoD) vs. Chronicles (CofD) — pick a universe

Choose Classic / oWoD if you want: rich fixed metaplot, ancient history, iconic factions, the biggest fanbase, and current 5th-edition support (Vampire, Werewolf, Hunter).

Choose Chronicles / CofD if you want: cleaner unified mechanics, a build-your-own-metaplot sandbox, and access to unique concepts with no Classic equivalent (Promethean, Deviant, Geist, Beast).

Rule of thumb: New to the hobby? Start with **Vampire: The Masquerade 5th Edition**. Want to play a regular person? Start with **Hunter: The Reckoning 5th Edition**. Want something nobody else is running? Pick up **Promethean** or **Deviant**.